

Technical report
Sparsifying l_2 regularized least squares regression
by biconjugate convex relaxation

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0.1 Linear least squares

$$(\text{RIDGE}^\beta) \begin{cases} \min & \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta \|x\|_2^2 \\ \text{s.t.} & x \in \mathbb{R}^n, \end{cases} \quad (1)$$

where $\beta > 0$ is a parameter.

0.2 Sparsifying linear least squares

We use a l_0 regularization approach to promote sparse solutions as expressed in the following problem

$$\begin{cases} \min & \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \rho \|x\|_0 + \beta \|x\|_2^2 \\ \text{s.t.} & x \in \mathbb{R}^n. \end{cases} \quad (2)$$

where $\rho \geq 0$ is a parameter which controls the sparsity of the solutions.

With $\delta := \sqrt{\frac{\rho}{\beta}}$, we have $\rho = \beta\delta^2$. The previous problem becomes

$$(\mathbb{P}^{\beta,\delta}) \begin{cases} \min & \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta\delta^2 \|x\|_0 + \beta \|x\|_2^2 \\ \text{s.t.} & x \in \mathbb{R}^n. \end{cases} \quad (3)$$

0.3 Relaxation $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$

Replacing $\|\cdot\|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} \|\cdot\|_2^2$ by its tightest convex under approximation, its biconjugate,

$$\left(\|\cdot\|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} \|\cdot\|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x),$$

see Le Thi et al., we obtain the following biconjugate relaxation (**BiConjugate Relaxation, BCR**)

$$(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}) \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} \min & F(x) := \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta\delta^2 \left(\|\cdot\|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} \|\cdot\|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x) \\ \text{s.t.} & x \in \mathbb{R}^n. \end{array} \right.$$

$(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ is a convex under approximation of $(\mathbb{P}^{\beta,\delta})$ and $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ solves $(\mathbb{P}^{\beta,\delta})$ when its solution satisfies particular global optimality conditions (see Le Thi et al.).

$$\left(\|\cdot\|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} \|\cdot\|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x) = \sum_i^n \left(|\cdot|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} |\cdot|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x_i),$$

$$\left(|\cdot|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} |\cdot|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x_i) = \frac{1}{\delta^2} x_i^2 - \frac{1}{\delta^2} \left[(\delta - |x_i|)^+ \right]^2 + 1 = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{\delta^2} x_i^2 + 1 & \text{if } |x_i| \geq \delta. \\ 2\frac{1}{\delta} |x_i| & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

0.3.1 Optimality conditions for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$

The following form for the optimality conditions are very useful for the theoretical study of the links between the biconjugate relaxation BCR, Ridge, Lasso and ElasticNet.

Optimality condition for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$

The optimality condition for the convex relaxation $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ is given by, Le Thi et al.

$$-2A^T(Ax - b) \in \beta\delta^2 \partial \left(\|\cdot\|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} \|\cdot\|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x).$$

As

$$\partial \left(|\cdot|_0 + \frac{1}{\delta^2} |\cdot|_2^2 \right)^{**} (x_i) = \begin{cases} \left\{ 2\frac{1}{\delta^2} x_i \right\} & \text{if } |x_i| \geq \delta, \\ \left\{ 2\frac{1}{\delta} \text{sign}(x_i) \right\} & \text{if } 0 < |x_i| \leq \delta, \\ \left[-2\frac{1}{\delta}, 2\frac{1}{\delta} \right] & \text{if } x_i = 0, \end{cases}$$

the condition becomes

$$\left(\mathbb{Q}_{opt}^{\beta, \delta}\right) [A^T(Ax - b)]_i \in \begin{cases} \{-\beta x_i\} & \text{if } |x_i| \geq \delta \\ \{-\delta\beta \text{sign}(x_i)\} & \text{if } 0 < |x_i| \leq \delta \\ [-\delta\beta, \delta\beta] & \text{if } x_i = 0. \end{cases}$$

or

$$[A^T(Ax - b) + \beta x]_i \in \begin{cases} \{0\} & \text{if } |x_i| \geq \delta \\ \{\beta x_i - \delta\beta \text{sign}(x_i)\} & \text{if } 0 < |x_i| \leq \delta \\ [-\delta\beta, \delta\beta] & \text{if } x_i = 0. \end{cases}$$

Proposition 0.3.1.1 $x = 0$ will be an optimal solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$ if and only if $\|A^T b\|_\infty \leq \delta\beta$.

Proof: Direct use of $(\mathbb{Q}_{opt}^{\beta, \delta})$. □

TO DO: study for the unicity or not of the solution!!!

Proposition 0.3.1.2 If x is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$ and $\delta < \min_{i \in \text{supp}(x)} |x_i|$, then x is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta'})$, for all δ' , $\delta \leq \delta' \leq \min_{i \in \text{supp}(x)} |x_i|$.

Proof: Direct use of $(\mathbb{Q}_{opt}^{\beta, \delta})$. □

0.3.2 Dual of $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$

Lagrangian dual of $(\text{DCR}^{\rho, \mu})$ is

$$(\text{DUAL}^{\rho, \mu}) \begin{cases} \max & G(\nu) := -\frac{1}{4} \|\nu\|_2^2 - b^T \nu - \rho(\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*(-\frac{A^T \nu}{\rho}) \\ \text{s.t.} & \nu \in \mathbb{R}^m. \end{cases}$$

With

$$(\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*(z) = \sum_i^m (\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*(z_i),$$

$$(\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*(z_i) = \left(\frac{1}{4\mu^2} z_i^2 - 1\right)^+ = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{4\mu^2} z_i^2 - 1 & \text{if } |z_i| \geq 2\mu \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Weak duality holds. As Slater's condition is satisfied, strong duality holds for $(\text{DCR}^{\rho, \mu})$.

This formulation will help to find a dual feasible efficiently!

Optimality condition for (DUAL^{ρ,μ})

The optimality condition for the convex program (DUAL^{ρ,μ}) is given by,

$$\frac{1}{2}\nu + b \in A\partial(\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*\left(-\frac{A^T\nu}{\rho}\right).$$

As

$$\partial(\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*(z_i) = \begin{cases} \left\{\frac{1}{2\mu^2}z_i\right\} & \text{if } |z_i| > 2\mu \\ \{0\} & \text{if } |z_i| < 2\mu \\ \left[0, \frac{1}{\mu}\right] & \text{if } z_i = 2\mu, \\ \left[-\frac{1}{\mu}, 0\right] & \text{if } z_i = -2\mu, \end{cases}$$

the condition becomes

$$\left(\text{DUAL}_{opt}^{\rho,\mu}\right) \frac{1}{2}\nu + b = Ay, \quad y_i \in \begin{cases} \left\{-\frac{1}{2\rho\mu^2} [A^T\nu]_i\right\} & \text{if } |[A^T\nu]_i| > 2\rho\mu \\ \{0\} & \text{if } |[A^T\nu]_i| < 2\rho\mu \\ \left[0, \frac{1}{\mu}\right] & \text{if } [A^T\nu]_i = -2\rho\mu, \\ \left[-\frac{1}{\mu}, 0\right] & \text{if } [A^T\nu]_i = 2\rho\mu. \end{cases}$$

Finding a dual feasible from a primal feasible

The previous primal and dual optimality conditions show that if x is a primal solution then $\nu = Ax - b$ is a dual solution.

Therefore for an arbitray feasible primal point x we define a dual feasible point $\nu = s\nu_0$, $\nu_0 = (Ax - b)$. The scalar s will be the argmax of the following 1D convex program:

$$\begin{cases} \max & -\frac{1}{4}\|\nu_0\|_2^2 s^2 - b^T\nu_0 s - \rho(\|\cdot\|_0 + \mu^2 \|\cdot\|_2^2)^*\left(-\frac{A^T\nu_0}{\rho}s\right) \\ s.t. & s \in \mathbb{R}, \end{cases}$$

say

$$\begin{cases} \max & -\frac{1}{4}\|\nu_0\|_2^2 s^2 - b^T\nu_0 s - \rho \sum_{i=1}^n \left(\frac{[A^T\nu_0]_i^2}{4\mu^2\rho^2} s^2 - 1\right)^+ \\ s.t. & s \in \mathbb{R}. \end{cases}$$

This is a piecewise 1D quadratic convex program. A solution will have necessarily the opposite sign of $b^T\nu_0$.

We will first solve

$$\begin{cases} \max & -\frac{1}{4}\|\nu_0\|_2^2 s^2 + |b^T\nu_0| s - \rho \sum_{i=1}^n \left(\frac{[A^T\nu_0]_i^2}{4\mu^2\rho^2} s^2 - 1\right)^+ \\ s.t. & s \geq 0, \end{cases}$$

and then update the sign of s .

Define

$$\theta_i = \frac{|[A^T \nu_0]_i|}{2\mu\rho}.$$

Let us consider the set with distinct and ordered elements γ_j

$$\begin{aligned} & \left\{ \frac{1}{\theta_i} : \theta_i \neq 0, i = 1, \dots, n \right\} \cup \{0, +\infty\} = \{\gamma_j : j = 1, \dots, p\}. \\ & \begin{cases} \max & -\frac{1}{4} \|\nu_0\|_2^2 s^2 + |b^T \nu_0| s - \rho \sum_{i=1, \theta_i \neq 0, \frac{1}{\theta_i} \leq \gamma_j} \theta_i^2 (s^2 - \frac{1}{\theta_i^2})^+ \\ \text{s.t.} & s \in [\gamma_j, \gamma_{j+1}], \end{cases} \\ & \begin{cases} \max & -\frac{1}{4} \|\nu_0\|_2^2 s^2 + |b^T \nu_0| s - \rho \sum_{i=1, \theta_i \neq 0, \frac{1}{\theta_i} \leq \gamma_j} \theta_i^2 (s^2 - \frac{1}{\theta_i^2}) \\ \text{s.t.} & s \in [\gamma_j, \gamma_{j+1}]. \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

So we will solve the following sequence of 1D convex quadratic programs

$$\begin{cases} \max & -\left[\frac{1}{4} \|\nu_0\|_2^2 + \rho \sum_{i=1, \theta_i \neq 0, \frac{1}{\theta_i} \leq \gamma_j} \theta_i^2 \right] s^2 + |b^T \nu_0| s + \rho \sum_{i=1, \theta_i \neq 0, \frac{1}{\theta_i} \leq \gamma_j} 1 \\ \text{s.t.} & s \in [\gamma_j, \gamma_{j+1}]. \end{cases}$$

$$a < 0, \left\{ \max a s^2 + b s + c : s \in [\gamma_j, \gamma_{j+1}] \right\} \leftrightarrow s = \begin{cases} \gamma_j & \text{if } -\frac{b}{2a} < \gamma_j, \\ \gamma_{j+1} & \text{if } -\frac{b}{2a} > \gamma_{j+1}, \\ -\frac{b}{2a} & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The sequence is solved efficiently using its incremental nature.

Duality gap

$G(\nu)$ lower bounds $F(x)$ and the corresponding duality gap

$$\eta := F(x) - G(\nu)$$

is always nonnegative from weak duality. x is no more than η -suboptimal. At the optimum the gap is zero from strong duality.

0.3.3 Theoretical links with Ridge and Lasso

Theoretical links with Ridge

Recall

$$(\text{RIDGE}^\beta) \begin{cases} \min & \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta \|x\|_2^2 \\ \text{s.t.} & x \in \mathbb{R}^n. \end{cases} \quad (4)$$

Ridge optimality condition $(2A^T(Ax - b) + 2\beta x = 0)$ can be written as

$$\left(\text{RIDGE}_{opt}^\beta \right) [A^T(Ax - b)]_i \in \{-\beta x_i\}.$$

Proposition 0.3.3.1 A RIDGE is always a $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$.

More precisely, assume A has no null column,

1. If x is a solution for (RIDGE^β) ,
then x is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ for all $\delta \leq \min_i |x_i|$.
2. If x is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ and $\delta \leq \min_i |x_i|$,
then x is a solution for (RIDGE^β) .

Proof: Direct use of $(\text{RIDGE}_{opt}^\beta)$ and $(\mathbb{Q}_{opt}^{\beta,\delta})$. □

Theoretical links with Lasso

$$(\text{LASSO}^\gamma) \begin{cases} \min & \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \gamma \|x\|_1 \\ \text{s.t.} & x \in \mathbb{R}^n. \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

Lasso optimality condition can be written as

$$\left(\text{LASSO}_{opt}^\gamma \right) [A^T(Ax - b)]_i \in \begin{cases} \left\{ -\frac{\gamma}{2} \text{sign}(x_i) \right\} & \text{if } x_i \neq 0 \\ \left[-\frac{\gamma}{2}, \frac{\gamma}{2} \right] & \text{if } x_i = 0. \end{cases}$$

Proposition 0.3.3.2 A LASSO is always a $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$.

More precisely,

1. If x is a solution for (LASSO^γ) ,
then x is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\frac{\gamma}{2\delta},\delta})$ for all $\delta \geq \max_{i \in \text{supp}(x)} |x_i|$.
2. If x is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ and $\delta \geq \max_{i \in \text{supp}(x)} |x_i|$,
then x is a solution for $(\text{LASSO}^{2\delta\beta})$.

Proof: Direct use of $(\text{LASSO}_{opt}^\gamma)$ and $(\mathbb{Q}_{opt}^{\beta,\delta})$. □

From Ridge to Lasso. How navigate $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$

Consider (RIDGE^β) , for a $\beta > 0$. (Assume A has no null column)
Define

$$\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta} := \min_{i \in \text{supp}(x^{\text{RIDGE}^\beta})} |x_i^{\text{RIDGE}^\beta}|.$$

Let us analyze δ s values.

We already have x^{RIDGE^β} solution of $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ for all $\delta \leq \delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta}$.

We will consider $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta} > \delta$.

From inequality $F(x^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}}) \leq F(0)$, we deduce

$$\left| x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \right| \leq \left\| x^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \right\|_1 \leq \frac{1}{2\delta\beta} F(0), \forall i.$$

So it suffices to constrain $\frac{1}{2\delta\beta} F(0) \leq \delta$ to ensure $\left| x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \right| \leq \delta$, for all i .

So $x^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}}$ is a solution of $(\text{LASSO}^{2\delta\beta})$, for all $\delta > \max \left\{ \sqrt{\frac{1}{2\beta} F(0)}, \delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta} \right\}$.

Define

$$\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta, \text{LASSO}} := \inf \left\{ \delta > \delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta} : x^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \text{ is a solution of } (\text{LASSO}^{2\delta\beta}) \right\}.$$

We also have necessarily

$$\rho_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta, \text{LASSO}} \leq \max \left\{ \sqrt{\frac{1}{2\beta} F(0)}, \delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta} \right\}.$$

Proposition 0.3.3.3 1. When δ moves from $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta}$ to $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta, \text{LASSO}}$, $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ moves from *RIDGE* to *LASSO*.

- before $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta}$, $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ is a *RIDGE*,
- after $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta, \text{LASSO}}$, $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ is a *LASSO*.

2. When δ moves strictly between $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta}$ and $\delta_{\text{RIDGE}^\beta, \text{LASSO}}$, $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ cannot be a *RIDGE* nor a *LASSO*.

The components of $x^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}}$ satisfy $\left(\mathbb{Q}_{\text{opt}}^{\beta,\delta} \right)$

$$\left[A^T (Ax^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} - b) \right]_i \in \begin{cases} \left\{ -\beta x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \right\} & \text{if } \left| x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \right| \geq \delta \\ \left\{ -\delta \beta \text{sign}(x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}}) \right\} & \text{if } 0 < \left| x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} \right| \leq \delta \\ [-\delta\beta, \delta\beta] & \text{if } x_i^{\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta}} = 0. \end{cases}$$

The second point of the previous proposition highlights the mixing role (on the components of x) played by $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$. The first line of the optimality condition is for *RIDGE*, with β , and the followings are for *LASSO*, with $\gamma := 2\delta\beta$. The value $\delta = \frac{\gamma}{2\beta}$ defines a trade-off line on the coordinates value.

0.3.4 Mixing roles: $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$ vs $(\text{ELASTICNET}^{\beta',\gamma})$

Theoretical links with ElasticNet

$$(\text{ELASTICNET}^{\beta',\gamma}) \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \min \\ \text{s.t.} \end{array} \begin{array}{l} \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta' \|x\|_2^2 + \gamma \|x\|_1 \\ x \in \mathbb{R}^n. \end{array} \right. \quad (6)$$

ElasticNet optimality condition can be written as

$$\left(\text{ELASTICNET}_{opt}^{\beta', \gamma} \right) [2A^T(Ax - b)]_i \in \begin{cases} \{-2\beta'x_i - \gamma \text{sign}(x_i)\} & \text{if } x_i \neq 0 \\ [-\gamma, \gamma] & \text{if } x_i = 0. \end{cases}$$

Proposition 0.3.4.1 *x is a common solution for $(\text{ELASTICNET}^{\beta', \gamma})$ and $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$ if and only if x is a solution of $(\text{ELASTICNET}^{\beta', \gamma})$ or $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$ and one of the following conditions holds:*

1. there exists C_1 , such that

$$|x_i| = C_1, \forall i, x_i \neq 0,$$

$$C_1 \geq \delta, \beta = \beta' + \frac{\gamma}{2C_1}.$$

2. there exists C_2 , such that

$$|x_i| = C_2, \forall i, x_i \neq 0,$$

$$C_2 \leq \delta, \delta\beta = \frac{\gamma}{2} + \beta'C_2.$$

3. there exist C_1 and C_2 , $C_2 \leq C_1$, such that

$$|x_i| = C_1 \text{ or } C_2, \forall i, x_i \neq 0,$$

$$\delta = \frac{C_1(\gamma + 2\beta'C_2)}{\gamma + 2\beta'C_1}, \delta\beta = \frac{\gamma}{2} + \beta'C_2.$$

Proof: Use $\left(\text{ELASTICNET}_{opt}^{\beta', \gamma} \right)$, $\left(\mathbb{Q}_{opt}^{\beta, \delta} \right)$ and compare solutions. □

0.4 Solving $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$

Let us denote by $x^\beta(\delta)$ a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$.

Proposition 0.4.0.1 *Let $\beta > 0$ and fixed.*

$x^\beta(\delta)$ is a piecewise linear function (TO DO why not mapping? think of it!!!) with respect to $\delta \geq 0$.

Proof: ... □

0.4.1 Cyclical coordinate descent for solving $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$

Algorithm 1 A cyclical coordinate descent for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$

- 1: Precompute $z_j := \sum_i^m A_{i,j}^2 = \|A_{.,j}\|_2^2$
- 2: Initialize $\hat{x} := 0$, (or something else)
- 3: **while** not converged **do**
- 4: **for** $j = 1, \dots, n$ **do**
- 5: Compute $\alpha_j := \sum_i^m A_{i,j}(b_i - \sum_{k \neq j} \hat{x}_k A_{i,k})$,
- 6: and set

$$\hat{x}_j := \begin{cases} 0 & |\alpha_j| \leq \delta\beta, \\ \frac{\alpha_j - \delta\beta \text{sign}(\alpha_j)}{z_j} & \delta\beta < |\alpha_j| \leq \delta\beta + \delta z_j, \\ \frac{\alpha_j}{\beta + z_j} & \delta\beta + \delta z_j \leq |\alpha_j|. \end{cases}$$

- 7: **end for**
 - 8: **end while**
 - 9: **return** $\hat{x}$
-

0.4.2 Interior point method

We will consider the convex quadratic form of $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta,\delta})$, see Le Thi et al.

$$\begin{cases} \min & \|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta\delta \|s + \delta v\|_2^2 - 2\beta\delta^2 e^T v \\ \text{s.t.} & -s_i \leq x_i \leq s_i, \ 0 \leq v_i, \ i = 1, \dots, n. \end{cases}$$

Logarithmic barrier for the bounds

$$\Phi(x, s, v) = - \sum_i^n \log(s_i + x_i) - \sum_i^n \log(s_i - x_i) - \sum_i^n \log(v_i).$$

$$\text{dom } \Phi = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} x \\ s \\ v \end{pmatrix} : -s_i < x_i < s_i, \ 0 < v_i, \ i = 1, \dots, n. \right\}.$$

The central path consists of the unique minimizer $(x(t), s(t), v(t))$ of the convex function

$$\phi_t(x, s, v) = t \left[\|Ax - b\|_2^2 + \beta\delta \|s + \delta v\|_2^2 - 2\beta\delta^2 e^T v \right] + \Phi(x, s, v).$$

Newton method is used to minimize ϕ_t , i.e, the search direction is computed as the exact solution to Newton system

$$H \begin{pmatrix} \Delta x \\ \Delta s \\ \Delta v \end{pmatrix} = -g.$$

The Hessian

$$H = \nabla^2 \phi_t(x, s, v),$$

and the gradient

$$g = \nabla \phi_t(x, s, v),$$

at the current iterate (x, s, v) .

...

0.4.3 Entire path direct solutions

This is a first approach that allow entire path solutions computation using Gauss eliminations. LARS like algorithm is also under progress!

Computing a new solution from a known one

Here we will consider that we have $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \underline{\delta}})$, $\underline{\delta} > 0$ and a corresponding solution $\underline{x} := x^\beta(\underline{\delta})$.

Let us define the following partition of the indices i , $i = 1, \dots, n$.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{K}_0 &:= \{i : |\underline{x}_i| > \underline{\delta}\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_1 &:= \{i : |\underline{x}_i| = \underline{\delta}, \text{Type 1}\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_2 &:= \{i : |\underline{x}_i| = \underline{\delta}, \text{Type 2}\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_3 &:= \{i : 0 < |\underline{x}_i| < \underline{\delta}\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_4 &:= \{i : \underline{x}_i = 0, \left| [A^T(A\underline{x} - b)]_i \right| = \underline{\delta}\beta, \text{Type 1}\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_5 &:= \{i : \underline{x}_i = 0, \left| [A^T(A\underline{x} - b)]_i \right| = \underline{\delta}\beta, \text{Type 2}\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_6 &:= \{i : \underline{x}_i = 0, 0 < \left| [A^T(A\underline{x} - b)]_i \right| < \underline{\delta}\beta\}, \\ \mathbb{K}_7 &:= \{i : \underline{x}_i = 0, [A^T(A\underline{x} - b)]_i = 0\}, \\ \underline{M} &:= \text{diag}(\underline{\theta}), \\ \underline{\theta}_i &:= \text{sign}(\underline{x}_i) \begin{cases} +1 & \text{if } \underline{x}_i > 0, \\ -1 & \text{if } \underline{x}_i < 0, \\ -\text{sign}([A^T(A\underline{x} - b)]_i) & \text{if } [A^T(A\underline{x} - b)]_i \neq 0, \\ +1 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

The following polyhedra contains $u := |\underline{x}|$ and $\delta := \underline{\delta}$, so is nonempty.

$$\begin{array}{llllll}
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \underline{\theta}_i u_i & & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_0 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \underline{\theta}_i u_i & & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_1 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \underline{\theta}_i u_i & + \beta \underline{\theta}_i t_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_2 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \underline{\theta}_i u_i & + \beta \underline{\theta}_i t_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_3 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \underline{\theta}_i u_i & + \beta \underline{\theta}_i t_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_4 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u & + \beta \underline{\theta}_i s_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_5 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u & + \beta \underline{\theta}_i s_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_6 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u & - \beta \underline{\theta}_i s_i & + \beta \underline{\theta}_i w_i & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_7 \\
u_i & & - t_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_0 \\
u_i & & - t_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_1 \\
u_i & & + t_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_2 \\
u_i & & + t_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_3 \\
u_i & & + t_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_4 \\
& s_i & + w_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_5 \\
& s_i & + w_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_6 \\
& s_i & + w_i & = \delta & i \in \mathbb{K}_7 \\
u \geq 0 & \delta \geq 0 & s \geq 0 & t \geq 0 & w \geq 0 \quad .
\end{array}$$

For $x := \underline{M}u$,

$$[A^T(Ax - b) + \beta x]_i = \begin{cases} 0 & 0 & i \in \mathbb{K}_0 \\ 0 & 0 & i \in \mathbb{K}_1 \\ -\beta \underline{\theta}_i t_i & \beta x - \delta \beta \text{sign}(x_i) & i \in \mathbb{K}_2 \\ -\beta \underline{\theta}_i t_i & \beta x - \delta \beta \text{sign}(x_i) & i \in \mathbb{K}_3 \\ -\beta \underline{\theta}_i t_i & \beta x - \delta \beta \text{sign}(x_i) & i \in \mathbb{K}_4 \\ -\beta \underline{\theta}_i s_i & -(\delta \beta - w_i \beta) \text{sign}(x_i) & i \in \mathbb{K}_5 \\ -\beta \underline{\theta}_i s_i & -(\delta \beta - w_i \beta) \text{sign}(x_i) & i \in \mathbb{K}_6 \\ \beta \underline{\theta}_i s_i - \beta \underline{\theta}_i w_i & -(-\delta \beta + 2w_i \beta) \text{sign}(x_i) & i \in \mathbb{K}_7 \end{cases}$$

Proposition 0.4.3.1 $x := \underline{M}u$ satisfies $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$ optimality conditions for δ sufficiently near $\underline{\delta}$.

Proof: ... □

How to choose δ ?

Our goal is to maximize $|\delta - \underline{\delta}|$ while keeping the polyhedral constraints valid.

Two cases $\delta := \underline{\delta} - \gamma$ or $\delta := \underline{\delta} + \gamma$, $\gamma \geq 0$. The first one will be used when starting from zero solution. The second one will be from Ridge solution.

Define τ ,

$$\tau := \begin{cases} +1 & \text{when starting from zero solution,} \\ -1 & \text{when starting from Ridge solution.} \end{cases}$$

So $\delta := \underline{\delta} - \tau\gamma$, in all cases.

We will maximize $|\delta - \underline{\delta}| = |-\tau\gamma| = \gamma$, over the previous polyhedra with green and red ones as basis, in all cases.

$\max \gamma$

$$\begin{array}{rclcl}
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \theta_i \underline{u_i} & & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_0 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \theta_i \underline{u_i} & & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_1 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \theta_i \underline{u_i} & + \beta \theta_i t_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_2 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \theta_i \underline{u_i} & + \beta \theta_i t_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_3 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u + \beta \theta_i \underline{u_i} & + \beta \theta_i t_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_4 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u & + \beta \theta_i s_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_5 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u & + \beta \theta_i s_i & & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_6 \\
(A^T \underline{AM})_i u & - \beta \theta_i s_i & + \beta \theta_i w_i & = (A^T b)_i & i \in \mathbb{K}_7 \\
u_i & + \tau\gamma & - t_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_0 \\
u_i & + \tau\gamma & - t_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_1 \\
u_i & + \tau\gamma & + t_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_2 \\
u_i & + \tau\gamma & + t_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_3 \\
u_i & + \tau\gamma & + t_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_4 \\
& \tau\gamma & + s_i & + w_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_5 \\
& \tau\gamma & + s_i & + w_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_6 \\
& \tau\gamma & + s_i & + w_i & = \underline{\delta} & i \in \mathbb{K}_7
\end{array}$$

$$u \geq 0 \quad \gamma \geq 0 \quad s \geq 0 \quad t \geq 0 \quad w \geq 0 \quad .$$

After Gauss elimination, for each row with 0 value on the right hand side and a nonnegative one on the γ column, do as follow

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{if } i \in \mathbb{K}_1 &\Rightarrow \mathbb{K}_1 := \mathbb{K}_1 \setminus \{i\}, \mathbb{K}_2 := \mathbb{K}_2 \cup \{i\} \\
\text{if } i \in \mathbb{K}_2 &\Rightarrow \mathbb{K}_2 := \mathbb{K}_2 \setminus \{i\}, \mathbb{K}_1 := \mathbb{K}_1 \cup \{i\} \\
\text{if } i \in \mathbb{K}_4 &\Rightarrow \mathbb{K}_4 := \mathbb{K}_4 \setminus \{i\}, \mathbb{K}_5 := \mathbb{K}_5 \cup \{i\} \\
\text{if } i \in \mathbb{K}_5 &\Rightarrow \mathbb{K}_5 := \mathbb{K}_5 \setminus \{i\}, \mathbb{K}_4 := \mathbb{K}_4 \cup \{i\}
\end{aligned}$$

and perform another Gauss elimination.

Proposition 0.4.3.2 *At most 2 eliminations are performed to reach optimality.*

Proof: ...

□

Proposition 0.4.3.3 *Let $\beta > 0$, fixed.*

- $\underline{x} := 0$ is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$,

$$\text{for all } \delta \geq \delta^0 := \frac{1}{\beta} \|A^T b\|_\infty.$$

- $\underline{x} := x^{Ridge^\beta}$ is a solution for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$,

$$\text{for all } \delta \leq \delta^{Ridge^\beta} := \min_{x_i^{Ridge^\beta} \neq 0} |x_i^{Ridge^\beta}|.$$

- From $\underline{\delta} := \delta^0$ and $\underline{x} := 0$, repeating the process until Ridge solution is attained gives us the full path and solutions for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$, $\delta \geq 0$ varying. Ridge solution is attained whenever $\underline{\delta} = \min_{i=1, \dots, n} |\underline{x}_i|$. (Assuming matrix A has no zero column)
- From $\underline{\delta} := \delta^{Ridge^\beta}$ and $\underline{x} := x^{Ridge^\beta}$, repeating the process until zero solution is attained gives us the full path and solutions for $(\mathbb{Q}^{\beta, \delta})$, $\delta \geq 0$ varying. Zero solution is attained whenever $\underline{\delta} = \delta^0$.

Proof: ...

□

	$\mathbb{K}_0$	$\mathbb{K}_1$	$\mathbb{K}_2$	$\mathbb{K}_3$	$\mathbb{K}_4$	$\gamma^1 \prime$	$b^1 \prime$
$\mathbb{K}_0$	?	?	?	?	?	γ^1	b^1
$\mathbb{K}_1$	?	?	?	?	?	γ^1	b^1
$\mathbb{K}_2$	?	?	$-\beta M_{K_2}$	?	?	$\gamma^1 - \beta M_{K_2} \gamma^2$	$b^1 - \beta M_{K_2} b^2$
$\mathbb{K}_3$	?	?	?	$-\beta M_{K_3}$	?	$\gamma^1 - \beta M_{K_3} \gamma^2$	$b^1 - \beta M_{K_3} b^2$
$\mathbb{K}_4$	?	?	?	?	$-\beta M_{K_4}$	$\gamma^1 - \beta M_{K_4} \gamma^2$	$b^1 - \beta M_{K_4} b^2$
$\mathbb{K}_5$	?	?	?	?	?	γ^1	b^1
$\mathbb{K}_6$	?	?	?	?	?	γ^1	b^1
$\mathbb{K}_7$	?	?	?	?	?	$\gamma^1 - \beta M_{K_3} \gamma^3$	$b^1 - \beta M_{K_3} b^3$
						$\gamma^2 \prime$	$b^2 \prime$
$\mathbb{K}_0$	I_{K_0}	0	0	0	0	γ^2	b^2
$\mathbb{K}_1$	0	I_{K_1}	0	0	0	γ^2	b^2
$\mathbb{K}_2$	0	0	I_{K_2}	0	0	γ^2	b^2
$\mathbb{K}_3$	0	0	0	I_{K_3}	0	γ^2	b^2
$\mathbb{K}_4$	0	0	0	0	I_{K_4}	γ^2	b^2
						$\gamma^3 \prime$	$b^3 \prime$
$\mathbb{K}_5$	0	0	0	0	0	γ^3	b^3
$\mathbb{K}_6$	0	0	0	0	0	γ^3	b^3
$\mathbb{K}_7$	0	0	0	0	0	γ^3	b^3

We denote by γ'' and b'' the columns corresponding to γ and right hand side b after Gauss elimination.

Define a diagonal matrix D^1 by

$$D_{ii}^1 := \begin{cases} -1 & \text{if } i \in \mathbb{K}_0 \cup \mathbb{K}_1, \\ +1 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

	$\mathbb{K}_0$	$\mathbb{K}_1$	$\mathbb{K}_2$	$\mathbb{K}_3$	$\mathbb{K}_4$	γ^1'''	b^1'''
$\mathbb{K}_0$	I_{K_0}	0	0	0	0	γ^1''	b^1''
$\mathbb{K}_1$	0	I_{K_1}	0	0	0	γ^1''	b^1''
$\mathbb{K}_2$	0	0	I_{K_2}	0	0	γ^1''	b^1''
$\mathbb{K}_3$	0	0	0	I_{K_3}	0	γ^1''	b^1''
$\mathbb{K}_4$	0	0	0	0	I_{K_4}	γ^1''	b^1''
$\mathbb{K}_5$	0	0	0	0	0	$\frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_5} \gamma^1''$	$\frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_5} b^1''$
$\mathbb{K}_6$	0	0	0	0	0	$\frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_6} \gamma^1''$	$\frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_6} b^1''$
$\mathbb{K}_7$	0	0	0	0	0	$-\frac{1}{2\beta} M_{K_7} \gamma^1''$	$-\frac{1}{2\beta} M_{K_7} b^1''$
						γ^2'''	b^2'''
$\mathbb{K}_0$	0	0	0	0	0	$D^1(\gamma^2'' - \gamma^1'')$	$D^1(b^2'' - b^1'')$
$\mathbb{K}_1$	0	0	0	0	0	$D^1(\gamma^2'' - \gamma^1'')$	$D^1(b^2'' - b^1'')$
$\mathbb{K}_2$	0	0	0	0	0	$D^1(\gamma^2'' - \gamma^1'')$	$D^1(b^2'' - b^1'')$
$\mathbb{K}_3$	0	0	0	0	0	$D^1(\gamma^2'' - \gamma^1'')$	$D^1(b^2'' - b^1'')$
$\mathbb{K}_4$	0	0	0	0	0	$D^1(\gamma^2'' - \gamma^1'')$	$D^1(b^2'' - b^1'')$
						γ^3'''	b^3'''
$\mathbb{K}_5$	0	0	0	0	0	$\gamma^3'' - \frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_5} \gamma^1''$	$b^3'' - \frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_5} b^1''$
$\mathbb{K}_6$	0	0	0	0	0	$\gamma^3'' - \frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_6} \gamma^1''$	$b^3'' - \frac{1}{\beta} M_{K_6} b^1''$
$\mathbb{K}_7$	0	0	0	0	0	$\gamma^3'' + \frac{1}{2\beta} M_{K_7} \gamma^1''$	$b^3'' + \frac{1}{2\beta} M_{K_7} b^1''$

0.5 Sparse Principal Component

Consider a covariance matrix Q .

Writing $Q = A^T A$ and $b := A\alpha$, we can see that

$$\|Ax - b\|_2^2 = (x - \alpha)^T Q (x - \alpha),$$

$$A^T (Ax - b) = Q(x - \alpha)$$

and

$$A^T b = Q\alpha.$$

0.6 Conclusion